

FilingLens

AI-Powered Financial Filing Intelligence for Retail Investors

PRODUCT PROPOSAL — MARCH 2026

Executive Summary

FilingLens is a B2B SaaS platform that transforms complex SEC financial filings (10-K, 10-Q, 8-K) into actionable investor insights through AI-powered analysis. We solve the critical information asymmetry between institutional investors — who employ teams of analysts — and retail investors who navigate 200-page filings alone.

Our positioning: Bloomberg Terminal intelligence at \$29/month for the everyday investor.

The Problem

Painpoint 1 — Information Asymmetry

57 million retail investors now hold significant stock positions, yet they lack the analytical tools that institutional investors take for granted. A 10-K filing is 200+ pages of dense technical language covering financial statements, footnotes, risk factors, and management discussion that often obscures rather than clarifies.

- Retail investors spend 5–8 hours manually reading and cross-referencing filings
- Most give up halfway through and make investment decisions on incomplete information
- Institutional investors have dedicated analyst teams to process the same data in minutes

Painpoint 2 — Red Flag Blindness

Professional analysts are trained to spot going-concern warnings, debt covenant violations, one-time revenue inflations, insider stock sales, and legal disclosures buried deep in filings. Retail investors systematically miss these signals.

- The average retail investor loses \$10K–\$30K annually from information disadvantage on just 2–3 positions
- Investors hold positions through value-destroying events that institutions exit within weeks

Painpoint 3 — Enterprise Pricing Lock-Out

Existing tools (Intelligize, Energent.ai, Brightwave) are enterprise-priced at \$500–\$10K/month, targeting law firms and hedge funds. They are not designed for individual investors and lack the narrative clarity non-experts need.

- There is no consumer-grade offering that combines speed, affordability, and plain-English clarity
- ChatGPT and Claude require manual prompt engineering with no SEC data integration or alerts

Painpoint 4 — Time-to-Insight Disadvantage

When a 10-K drops, institutional investors have analyst reports within hours. Retail investors wait days or weeks for financial media coverage — by which time the market has already repriced the stock.

- A 24-hour insight window becomes a 5-day disadvantage for the retail investor

Why FilingLens

Democratized Intelligence

FilingLens brings analyst-grade insights to the 57 million retail investors who previously had no access. Our pricing (\$29/month, free tier, pay-as-you-go) is 15–30x cheaper than enterprise alternatives, removing cost as the primary barrier.

Red Flag Detection at Scale

Our AI analysis is purpose-built to catch the warning signs individual investors miss, presented as plain-English warnings with citations and actionable follow-up questions — not raw data dumps.

- Going Concern (auditor doubt)
- Debt & Liquidity (covenant violations, refinancing cliffs)
- Revenue Quality (one-time items, deferred revenue manipulation)
- Management Language (metric switches, hedging, buried disclosures)
- Legal & Regulatory (undisclosed exposure)
- Insider Activity (executive departures, unusual stock sales)
- Auditor Signals (material weakness, late filing, auditor change)

Speed and Simplicity

Upload a 10-K → summary + red flags delivered within 5–10 minutes. No setup, no integrations, no compliance overhead. Sign up and start analyzing immediately.

Built for Speed-to-Market

We are not starting from zero. FilingLens is a re-application of proven document intelligence architecture — the same pipelines, LLM integration patterns, and multi-tenant SaaS infrastructure already operational on thousands of legal documents — now pointed at financial filings.

Core Product Features

Intelligent Filing Summary

Converts a 200-page 10-K into a 5-bullet plain-English executive summary. Retail investors get a CFO's mental model of a business in 90 seconds.

Red Flag Detection Engine

Scans 7 risk categories that correlate with stock underperformance, combining deterministic numeric extraction with LLM-based language analysis. Each flag includes severity rating, evidence quote, and follow-up question.

Year-over-Year Comparator

Auto-diffs current and prior-year filings. Surfaces what changed in revenue, margins, risk language, and management guidance — and whether changes were disclosed or buried.

Ask-the-Filing Chat

RAG-powered Q&A; lets investors ask natural language questions against the full filing. 'What is their exposure to supply chain disruption?' — answered with exact section citations.

Watchlist Alerts

Monitors companies and delivers instant analysis within 10 minutes of a new filing. Retail investors get institutional-speed insights for the first time.

How We Extract and Analyze

FilingLens uses a hybrid extraction approach combining deterministic and LLM-based pipelines, orchestrated through DocETL.

Phase 1 — Deterministic Extraction

Financial data must be precise. We cannot hallucinate a company's revenue. Deterministic extraction ensures accuracy for foundational facts before any LLM processing begins.

- PDF parsing → structured plain text
- Financial table extraction (balance sheet, income statement, cash flow)
- Pattern matching for numeric thresholds (debt levels, revenue, margins)
- SEC structure parsing to identify sections (Item 1A, Item 7 MD&A, etc.)

Output: Structured JSON with extracted financials, section boundaries, and metadata.

Phase 2 — LLM-Based Analysis

Qualitative insights — language patterns, tone shifts, contextual risk — can only be reliably extracted by frontier language models. A keyword search for 'going concern' catches 80% of cases; an LLM catches 99% and understands severity and nuance.

- Red flag detection: LLM scans risk language, management tone, footnote disclosures
- Comparative analysis: identifies narrative shifts and metric changes vs. prior year
- Plain-English synthesis: transforms raw data into investor-friendly insights
- Frontier models (Claude / GPT-4 class) used for nuanced strategic reasoning

Output: Scored red flags, narrative summaries, management insights, investor questions.

Phase 3 — DocETL Orchestration

DocETL chains deterministic and LLM steps together, handles errors gracefully, reuses extracted data across multiple analyses (avoiding redundant LLM calls), and scales horizontally to process multiple filings in parallel.

Step	Type	Input	Output
PDF Parse	Deterministic	Raw PDF	Plain Text
Table Extract	Deterministic	Plain Text	Financial JSON
Section Parse	Deterministic	Plain Text	Structured Sections
Red Flag Scan	LLM	Sections + Financials	Risk Flags JSON
YoY Compare	LLM	Current + Prior JSON	Change Analysis
Summarize	LLM	All Sections	Narrative Summary
Deliver	Deterministic	All Outputs	Dashboard / Alert

Monetization Model

Tier	Price	Limits	Use Case
Free	\$0	5 filings/month, 3 watchlisted companies	Casual investor trying the platform
Pro	\$29/month	Unlimited filings, 10 watchlist companies, alerts	Individual investor, regular analysis
Analyst	\$79/month	Unlimited + CSV exports, API access	Serious trader, portfolio manager
Team	\$149/month	5 seats, shared watchlists, Slack/Telegram alerts	Investment club, wealth advisor

Additional revenue streams: One-time Deep Dive Reports (\$9–\$19 each), API partnerships with fintech platforms (\$500–\$2K/month), and premium data export add-ons.

Competitive Landscape

Competitor	Target	Price	Gap FilingLens Fills
Intelligize	Corporate legal / hedge funds	\$500+/mo	Enterprise-only, not for retail
eliSec	Alert-focused traders	Freemium	No deep analysis, no plain-English context
Seeking Alpha Premium	Individual investors	\$200/year	No AI analysis, crowdsourced content
ChatGPT / Claude	General users	\$20/mo	No SEC integration, manual prompt engineering
FilingLens	Retail investors	\$29/mo	First consumer-grade AI-native solution

Go-to-Market Strategy

Phase 1 — Community Growth (Months 1–3)

- Reddit: r/investing (2.8M members), r/stocks (5.8M members), r/SecurityAnalysis — post free analyses, seed organic growth
- Twitter/FinTwit: Share 'red flags caught before the crash' stories with proof
- Product Hunt: Day 1 launch with heavy engagement push

Phase 2 — SEO & Content (Months 3–6)

- Target high-intent keywords: '[Company] 10-K analysis,' '[Company] red flags,' 'how to read a 10-K'
- Publish weekly filing analyses for major companies (Apple, Tesla, Meta)

Phase 3 — B2B Partnerships (Months 6+)

- Partner with robo-advisors, wealth platforms, financial content sites via API
- Embed FilingLens analysis into partner platforms, scaling distribution without paid CAC

Revenue Milestones

Milestone	Free Users	Paying Customers	MRR
Month 1 (Launch)	500	50 Pro	\$1,450
Month 3	2,000	300 Pro + 20 Analyst	\$9,500
Month 6	8,000	1,000 Pro + 100 Analyst + 10 Team	\$31,500
Month 12	30,000	3,500 Pro + 400 Analyst + 50 Team	\$110,000+

Conclusion

FilingLens is a consumer-grade, AI-native platform that bridges the information asymmetry between institutional and retail investors. We address a proven, quantified pain point — retail investors losing \$10K–\$30K annually to information disadvantage — with a solution that is faster, cheaper, and clearer than anything currently available.

By combining deterministic extraction for accuracy, LLM analysis for insight, consumer-first design for simplicity, and aggressive pricing for accessibility, we unlock a \$600M–\$2.4B TAM and position FilingLens as the default financial analysis tool for the 57 million retail investors who have never had one.

The market is ready. The technology is ready. It's time to ship.